

Sometimes you can ask God to show you the truth, and then spend the rest of your time arguing with Him about the answer.

Not because you do not trust Him.

Because you do not like what He is showing you.

I think that is one of the strangest things about faith.

You can genuinely say,

God, show me.

Show me what I am not seeing.

Show me what I am doing wrong.

Show me who these people really are.

Show me whether this is where I am supposed to be.

Show me whether I should take this job.

Show me whether I should accept this opportunity.

Show me whether this house is right for me.

Show me whether I should stay in this environment.

Show me whether this person is good for me.

Show me what I need to know so I can make the decision that is right for where You are taking me.

And then you wait.

And sometimes He shows you.

And your first response is,

No.



Surely not.

That cannot be what You mean.

Maybe I am imagining things.

Maybe I am insecure.

Maybe I am afraid because this matters too much to me.

Maybe I am overthinking.

And suddenly you are cross examining God like He has presented evidence in court and you are the defence attorney.

Your Honour, respectfully, I would like to challenge this revelation.

The problem is that sometimes we think we are asking for the truth when what we are really asking for is reassurance.

We want God to confirm what we have already decided.

We want Him to say,

Yes, this person is exactly who you think they are.

Yes, this opportunity is safe.

Yes, take the job.

Yes, move into that house.

Yes, stay.

Yes, everything is fine.

And when the answer looks different, suddenly we become very creative.

We find explanations.

We negotiate.

We rationalise.

We tell ourselves we are being mature.

We tell ourselves we are not going to be paranoid.

We tell ourselves we are simply giving people the benefit of the doubt.

Sometimes that is wisdom.

Sometimes it is denial wearing a very respectable outfit.

I know because I have done it.

There was a season in my life when the dreams became so frequent that I became angry at myself for having them.

They were not vague dreams either.

They were detailed.

Specific.

Sometimes there were conversations.

Sometimes there were names.

Sometimes there were situations that felt so oddly precise that I would wake up and think,

What on earth was that?

And then I would go about my day and try to forget them.

Because I did not want them.

I did not ask for them.

And more importantly, I did not want them to be true.

So I did what people do when they are frightened by something they cannot explain.

I explained it away.

It's my insecurity.

It's because I care too much.

It's because I am scared of losing this.

It's because my mind is trying to prepare me for something.

It's just a dream.

And sometimes I would practically argue with myself.

Girl, please.

Get a grip.

Not everything is a sign.

And I agreed with myself.

For a while.

Then another dream came.

Then another.

Then another.

The details became too specific.

The names kept appearing.

Certain situations kept repeating.

And the worst part was that I did not want to know.

I wanted to be wrong.

I wanted to wake up one morning and laugh at myself.

I wanted to say,

See? I knew I was being dramatic.

I wanted the names to be wrong.

I wanted the people not to exist.

I wanted the conversations not to have happened.

I wanted reality to come along and rescue me from what my own mind, my own intuition, or my understanding of God seemed to be putting in front of me.

At some point, the doubt became unbearable.

And I crossed a privacy boundary.

I looked where I should not have looked.

I am not proud of that.

I am not writing this to make that decision righteous.

It was a boundary, and I crossed it.

But I also think there is something important about being honest about why I did it.

I was desperate for certainty.

I wanted to prove myself wrong.

That is the part people might misunderstand.

I was not looking because I wanted to find something.

I was looking because I desperately wanted to find nothing.

I wanted to be able to go back to God and say,

See?

You were wrong.

Or perhaps more accurately,

I was wrong about what I thought You were showing me.

I wanted to prove the names were wrong.

I wanted to prove those people did not know each other.

I wanted to prove those conversations had never happened.

I wanted to prove that all those dreams were simply my fears dressing themselves up as intuition.

I wanted evidence that would allow me to go back to sleep peacefully.

Instead, I found things that made me sit there in silence.

And that was when I realised something that broke my heart in a way I was not prepared for.

I had spent so much time asking God to reveal the truth.

And when I thought He had, I spent even more time trying to convince myself that He hadn't.

Because sometimes the truth is not difficult to recognise.

It is difficult to accept.

There is a difference.

You can know something and still spend months emotionally refusing to know it.

You can see the red flag and start explaining why it is probably just the lighting.

You can feel uncomfortable in a room and convince yourself that you are simply tired.

You can meet someone and feel something is off, then spend weeks telling yourself that you are being judgmental.

You can receive a job offer that looks perfect on paper but every time you pray about it, something in you says, *No.*

And you say,

I am scared.

You can find a house that is beautiful, affordable and exactly what you thought you wanted, but something about it does not sit right.

And you say,

I am being difficult.

You can walk into an environment where everyone tells you how good it is, but something inside you keeps whispering,

Do not stay here.

And you say,

Maybe I am just afraid of change.

You can be given an opportunity you have prayed for for years and still feel a strange resistance toward it.

And because you have spent so long believing that blessings are supposed to feel like excitement, you assume the discomfort must be fear.

So you force yourself to say yes.

Sometimes it is fear.

Sometimes it is insecurity.

Sometimes it is trauma.

Sometimes it is overthinking.

Sometimes your intuition is wrong.

That is why I do not think the answer is to blindly obey every feeling you have.

Discernment requires honesty.

But honesty also means allowing yourself to consider that the feeling might be telling you something.

Without immediately humiliating yourself for having it.

I think we have become very good at calling ourselves insecure whenever our instincts inconvenience us.

We say,

I am probably overthinking.

I am probably imagining it.

I am probably being dramatic.

And sometimes we are.

But sometimes we are not.

Sometimes we are simply noticing something before we have the language to explain it.

And that is where I have had to learn a different kind of patience.

I do not have to immediately decide what a feeling means.

I can sit with it.

I can pray about it.

I can observe.

I can ask questions.

I can wait for patterns.

I can let reality confirm or correct what I think I am seeing.

Most importantly, I can stop forcing myself to believe something is fine simply because I desperately want it to be fine.

Because that was my mistake.

I thought doubting myself made me humble.

I thought constantly questioning my intuition made me reasonable.

I thought giving someone the benefit of the doubt meant ignoring what I was feeling.

It doesn't.

There is humility in saying,

I might be wrong.

There is also humility in saying,

I might be right.

Both require you to leave room for the truth.

And perhaps that is what prayer has taught me most.

If I ask God to reveal something, I have to make peace with the possibility that the answer will not look anything like what I wanted.

I cannot say,

Show me the truth, but please make it comfortable.

Show me who they are, but please let them still be who I need them to be.

Show me whether I should stay, but please do not let the answer be leave.

Show me whether this job is right, but please do not tell me no because I really need the money.

Show me whether this house is right, but please do not tell me to walk away because I have already imagined my curtains.

Because sometimes we are not actually asking for guidance.

We are asking God to bless a decision we have already made.

And when He refuses to cooperate with our plans, we call the discomfort fear.

I have done that.

I have prayed for answers and then argued with the answers.

I have asked for clarity and then begged myself to misunderstand it.

I have asked to be shown what I could not see and then become angry when I saw it.

I have even gone looking for proof that I was wrong.

And when I found confirmation instead, I had to sit with the uncomfortable knowledge that perhaps the problem was never that God was not answering me.

Perhaps I simply did not want the answer.

That is a difficult thing to admit.

Especially when you love someone.

Especially when you have built a future around something.

Especially when you have prayed over it.

Especially when you have told everyone how excited you are.

Especially when walking away means admitting that you were hoping for one answer while receiving another.

But I am learning that an answer does not become wrong because I dislike it.

A closed door does not become an open door because I stand there long enough.

A warning does not become insecurity simply because I wish it were.

And the truth does not become a lie because I am not emotionally prepared for it.

Sometimes God shows you.

And you cry.

Sometimes He shows you.

And you get angry.

Sometimes He shows you.

And you say, *No, surely not.*

Sometimes He shows you.

And you spend months trying to prove Him wrong.

And perhaps the real test is not whether we can ask for the truth.

Perhaps the real test is whether we are willing to recognise it when it arrives.

Because eventually, I had to stop asking,

Why didn't I know?

And start asking,

Why did I keep refusing to know?

That question changed something in me.

I don't want to become a person who distrusts everyone.

I don't want to treat every dream like a prophecy.

I don't want to turn every uncomfortable feeling into a warning.

I don't want to live suspiciously.

I want discernment.

I want the wisdom to know the difference between fear and intuition.

Between anxiety and conviction.

Between insecurity and observation.

Between a closed door and my own reluctance to walk through it.

And perhaps most importantly, I want the courage to say,

God, if I ask You to show me, I promise I will not demand that You show me what I want to see.

Because maybe faith is not believing that God will give us the answer we want.

Maybe faith is believing that when the answer comes, we will survive knowing it.

Even when we have to sit there afterwards and whisper,

Okay.

I did not want that answer.

But I asked You for the truth.

And now I know.

